

Chapter 8

Curate Your Community

When Jen and I (Jill) first met, we were both reluctant to hang out. I was on a three-week road trip with Eric in the RV we lived in, and I wasn't exactly interested in collecting new friends while traveling. But Eric, being the extrovert he is and remembering he might know some people in St. Petersburg (one of our stops on our East Coast tour), put out a Facebook post to see if anyone was interested in hanging out. He thought maybe the acquaintances he made years ago while on tour with a band would see it and want to hang. They didn't. But since Jen happened to be Facebook friends with Eric after meeting at a party in San Diego ten years prior but never talking again, his post showed up in her feed.

And when Jen noticed no one responded to Eric's invitation to hang, she felt bad and reached out to offer a group outing at a bar that served free shots at sunset. To be fair, in my memory, it was small glasses of champagne, but Jen always corrects me; it wasn't that bougie.

Our encounter was out of the norm for both of us. I wanted to rest and not spend precious energy "meeting someone I will never talk to again," and Jen wears headphones when she takes her kids to the park to avoid chatting with other parents, so she also isn't the "meet up with strangers at the beach" type. But we took a chance and did something different. As a result, we found something really amazing. We formed a fast friendship and started our own podcast a year later out of the realization that more people could benefit from a friendship like this!